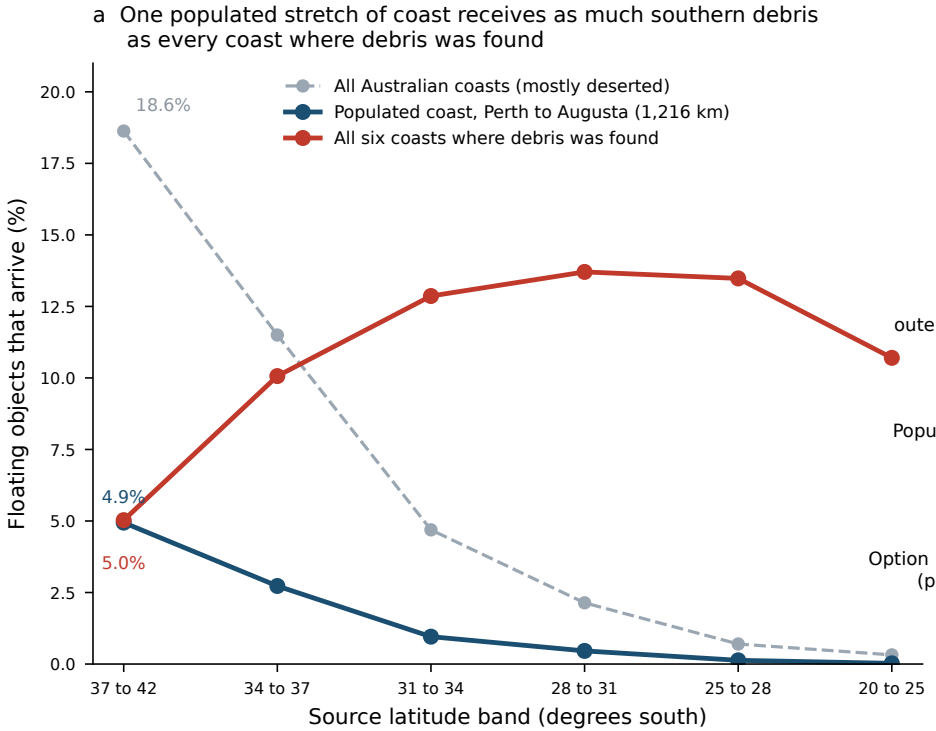
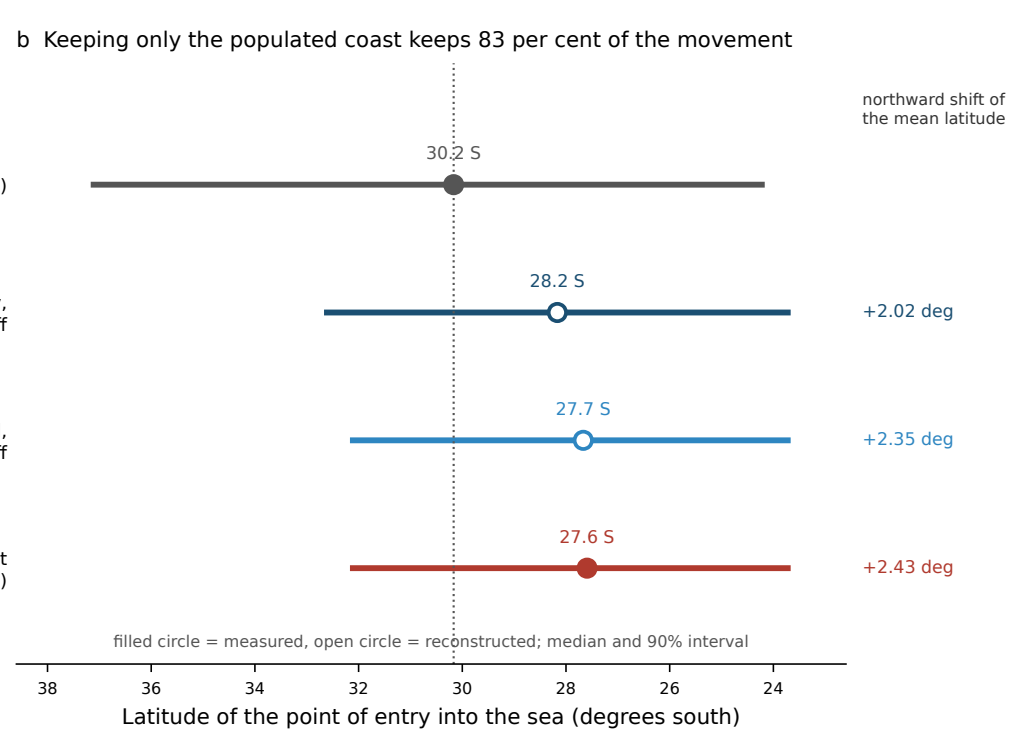
The Australian non-recovery evidence does not depend on the deserted coasts





Plain-language note. Australia has no confirmed debris. The question here is whether that absence still carries weight if only coasts where people live are allowed to count. Inside the model area, the only populated Australian coast that receives debris is the stretch from Perth to Augusta, about 1,216 km. The left panel shows that this one stretch receives as many floating objects from southern starting points as all six coasts where debris was really found. The right panel shows what happens when the deserted coasts are switched off: almost all of the movement to the north stays.

Technical note. Debris drift module, Australian non-recovery term (gap G26), Pete's ruling of 15 Oct 2026 that only populated coast should carry the non-recovery evidence. Source: the completed interim pilot of 12-13 Oct 2026 (GLORYS12 + ERA5, 175 nodes, 1e5 particles per node, window 8 Mar 2014 - 30 Jun 2016, beaching on entry to the model land mask, no refloat); no transport was run. Panel a: per-segment arrival probability, mean over the three object classes; populated = ABS RA 2021 major city and inner regional (segment AU-wa-city-inner, Perth to Augusta, 114.8-115.9 E; the south and north-east city segments lie east of 120 E and receive 0.0 per cent by construction). Panel b: the two middle rows are POST-HOC RECONSTRUCTIONS, not runs, defined after the pilot result was seen; the per-node change is predicted by the saturating law -k ln(1 + W/(c F)) with k 3.50 and c 0.204 fitted to the measured B and C columns (W = detection-weighted Australian arrivals, F = find-coast arrivals). Held-out check: fitted on B alone it predicts C with a residual of +0.07 nat, standard deviation 0.50, and it reproduces the measured shift of B as +2.41 against +2.43 deg. Change in log evidence under the reconstruction: populated only -0.61 nat, populated and outer regional -0.76, B -0.80 (the law understates the measured B value of -1.08, so these are conservative). REACH-LIMITED: 15-120 E, so the populated south-east coast near Adelaide, Melbourne and Hobart is not tracked. Interim, not evidence; run I not converged; not composed; no Bayes factor.